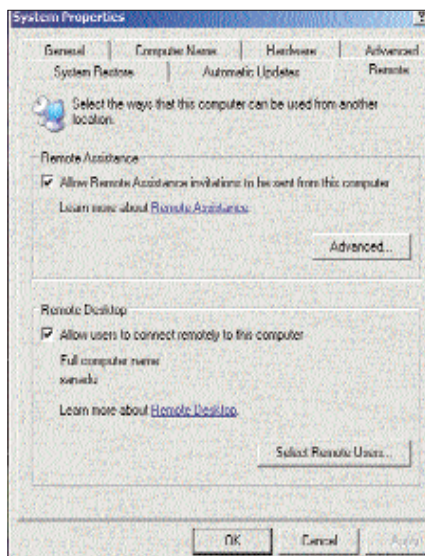
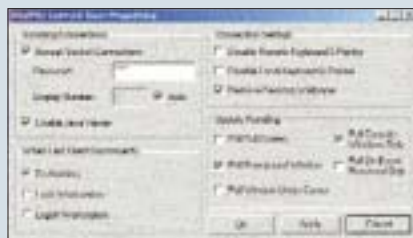




Turn on remote services on the Windows XP Professional host computer in the Remote Tab of the System Properties Dialog

## Virtually Computing

Virtual Network Computing (VNC), a product of open source engineering, has a number of distributions existing currently. RealVNC is one such version that's free and reasonably small in size. Also its winning point is that it lets you connect to any Windows PC.



Configure VNC on the server before you connect to another remotely

Install RealVNC on both, the remote computer as well as the local PC. Go to **Start > Programs > RealVNC** on the host PC and select 'Run VNC Server'. This pops up the Properties menu. Under Incoming connections, check 'Accept Socket Connections' and enter a password for the session. Click on OK to start the server. On the server, navigate to **Start > Programs > RealVNC** and select 'Run VNC viewer' to start the VNC viewer. Here, enter the IP address. Once a connection is established, you will be prompted for the session password that you had provided earlier. You should now be able to remotely access the machine.

Click on Options in Remote Desktop Connection. Here, in General, set all the options related to Logon settings. Save your previously entered sessions, along with the authentication details in Connection Settings, so that you can log on without entering a user name and password. Tweak the keyboard and sound options under 'Local Resources'. Programs lets you start programs when you connect, and Experience lets you set the kind of eye candy that's acceptable, considering your connection speed. Keep the eye candy to a minimum, and set the Colors options (within the Display tab), to a lower value if you have low bandwidth connectivity. Also, remember to change the resolution to an appropriate value.

Now, specify the computer that you intend to connect to. Enter in the host's name or IP address, and click Connect. A



You need to log into a remote machine to start a remote session

logon prompt comes up. Enter the username and password.

During the session, the host is locked. Unlock it by pressing **[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del]**, and the remote session is terminated.

## There's more

Remote Desktop can be used in full-screen mode, or as a windowed session. The default settings apply keyboard shortcuts for the full-screen mode. Hence, you get the feeling of physically operating your host PC. In fact, just about everything



Use Remote Desktop to copy text across PCs, and more

appears as though you are physically on that host computer—your disk drives, your mapped and network drives and network shares, and so on—all your PC's resources are literally at your fingertips, and you could start file transfers and send and receive e-mails or review documents.

Remote Desktop can also be used inside an office to collaborate over a project, or share an idea with the rest of your colleagues. Since most remote connections support text and graphics cutting and pasting through the clipboard, you can cut out or copy text from the remote machine and paste it to a local document as often as needed. 

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Though using VNC is a breeze, the end results aren't the best possible. While running it on PCs connected to a 100 Mbps LAN, we found that Remote Desktop works more smoothly than VNC when connecting two Windows XP Professional machines to one another. VNC displayed a slight lag.

VNC supports copying and pasting text, but we couldn't get graphics pasted. However, nothing beats the fact that it lets you connect to just about any Windows machine. It also comes with support for lots of other platforms and being an open



Use VNC to be able to remote control any PC

source product, it's bound to get better.

Hence Remote Desktop is the best tool to use while connecting across to a Windows XP Professional system. Opt for RealVNC if you intend to connect remotely to any other Windows PC.